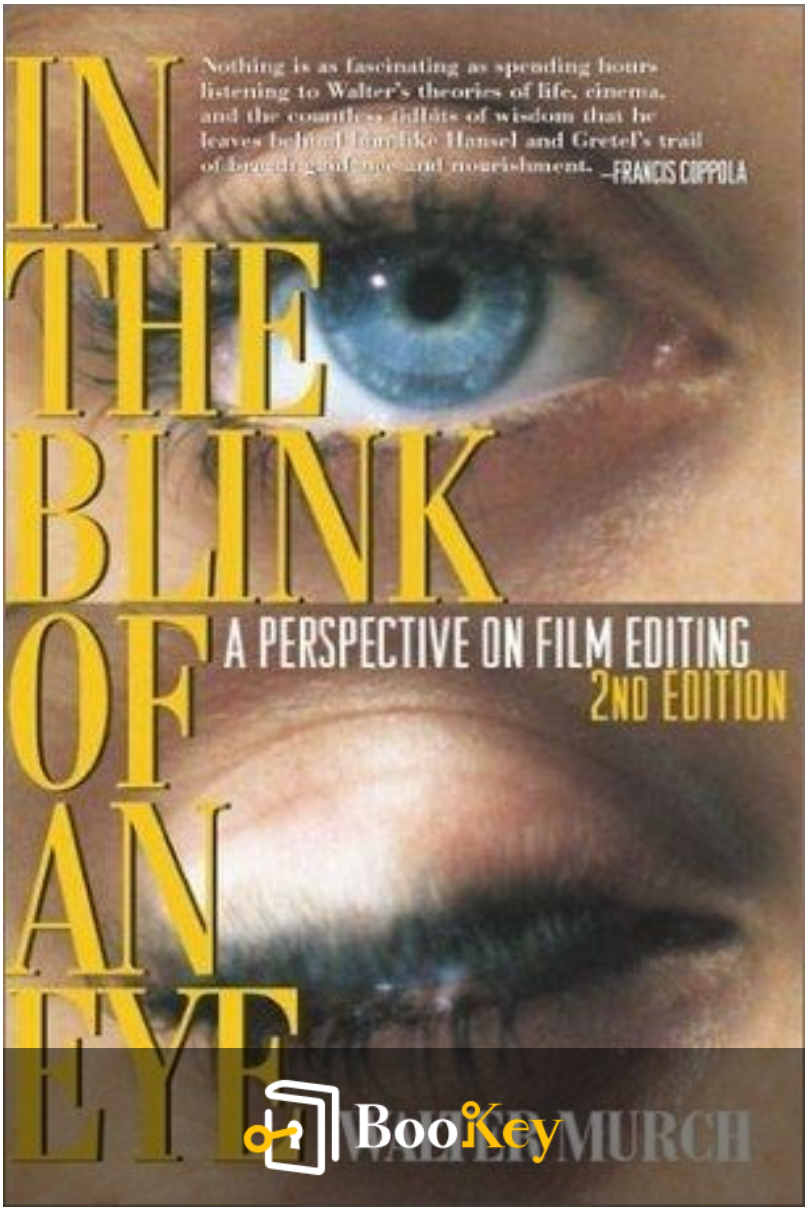
In the Blink of an Eye PDF

Walter Murch



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In the Blink of an Eye

Exploring the Art and Science of Film Editing.

Written by Bookey

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About the book

In the Blink of an Eye is a profound and engaging exploration of film editing by renowned editor Walter Murch. Delving into the fundamental question of why cuts resonate with audiences, Murch takes readers on an insightful journey through the art and mechanics of editing. He examines themes such as continuity, the interplay between dreams and reality, and the emotional significance of a simple blink. This second edition reflects Murch's revised perspectives on digital editing, addressing the rapid technological shifts that have occurred since the first edition, making it a timely and thought-provoking resource for filmmakers and enthusiasts alike.

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About the author

Walter Murch is a renowned American film editor, director, writer, and sound designer, celebrated for his influential work on iconic films such as THX 1138, Apocalypse Now, The Godfather trilogy, American Graffiti, The Conversation, Ghost, and The English Patient. He has received three Academy Awards from nine nominations, including groundbreaking recognition for his role as the first credited "Sound Designer" for Apocalypse Now. Additionally, Murch played a key role in the restoration of Orson Welles's Touch of Evil and contributed to the editing of Apocalypse Now Redux. Author of the acclaimed book on film editing, In the Blink of an Eye, Murch has been described by movie critic Roger Ebert as “the most respected film editor and sound designer in modern cinema” and hailed by David Thomson as a “scholar, gentleman, and superb craftsman” without peer in his field.

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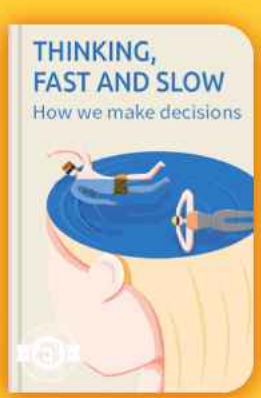
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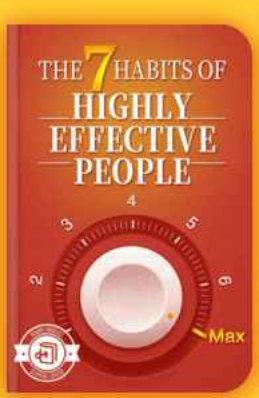
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Chapter 13 : Don't Worry,It's Only a Movie

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Chapter 1 Summary : Cuts and Shadow Cuts



Summary of Chapter 1: In the Blink of an Eye

Introduction to the Author's Insights

Walter Murch reflects on the thoughts presented in his lecture as personal cautionary notes and working methods developed through his experiences. He expresses gratitude to those who aided in sharing his insights and updates on filmmaking techniques.

Filmmaking Experience and Context

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Murch emphasizes the uniqueness of each film's creation process, noting that "Apocalypse Now" serves as a prime example of cinematic challenges. His involvement in the lengthy post-production highlights the complexities of editing, with an unprecedented 1,250,000 feet of film recorded, resulting in a 95-to-1 unseen-minute-to-finished-minute ratio.

Editing Process and Challenges

The editing journey is likened to traversing a forest, illustrating the uneven coverage of scenes within the film. Specific examples, such as the extensive coverage of the helicopter attack sequence and minimalistic connecting scenes, showcase the contrasts in editing demands.

Editor’s Daily Output

Murch calculates the rate of cuts made by the editing team, revealing a figure of 1.47 cuts per editor per day during the editing of "Apocalypse Now." He concludes that even with focused efforts, the lengthy editing process reflected the complexities inherent in film editing.

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Conclusion

The chapter highlights that editing is not just about the number of cuts but involves navigating vast amounts of material, making it a unique and often protracted process, as illustrated by the experience of editing "Apocalypse Now."

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Chapter 2 Summary : Why Do Cuts Work?



Summary of Chapter 2 from "In the Blink of an Eye"

The Role of an Editor

The editing process is primarily about discovering a path rather than merely splicing film. An editor spends most of their time evaluating numerous possible cuts, which is especially complex in films with a high shooting ratio, like "Apocalypse Now." The blend of sensitive subject matter, innovative technical approaches, and personal investment

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from the director contributes to this complexity. The exhaustive effort behind each cut often involves many "shadow" splices—those considered but ultimately discarded.

The Art of Cutting

Film consists of various pieces edited together, creating what is perceived as a coherent narrative despite the spontaneous displacement of image and time caused by cuts. Evolution and daily experience have not prepared us to reject film editing, which can be both jarring and seamless. The discovery of effective cuts allowed filmmakers to move beyond the continuous shot, leading to greater creative freedom.

Discontinuity in Filmmaking

Discontinuity is essential in filmmaking; it allows for the selection of the optimal camera angles that enhance emotional and narrative power. Practical challenges arise in executing long continuous takes, which can lead to increased error potential. Cutting enables editors to create sharper, more impactful films.

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Visual Representation and Perception

Discontinuity also resonates with historical visual art; different angles used in ancient paintings create a unique perception of figures, akin to modern film techniques. Cuts serve both a practical purpose and as a constructive element in filmmaking, creating dynamic transitions that challenge our perceptions, much like the enigma of flight in nature.

Conclusion

Cuts in film operate effectively despite their paradoxical nature. Understanding why cuts "work" remains a complex and intriguing aspect of the editing process, comparable to the surprising capabilities of bumblebees.

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Example

Key Point:Understanding the Complexity of Cuts in Film Editing

Example:Imagine you are editing a sequence from your own home video, faced with various angles captured during a family gathering. You play each clip repeatedly, weighing the emotional impact of your mother's laughter compared to your child's candid smile. Each time you cut, you feel the weight of the decision—will this frame convey the joy of the moment, or will it obscure it? Just like an editor working on a feature film, the process of selecting which moment to highlight is an exploration of narrative and emotion, revealing that editing is less about just splicing footage and more about curating an experience that resonates.

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Chapter 3 Summary : "Cut Out the Bad Bits"

Cut Out the Bad Bits

Introduction to Editing

Walter Murch recounts a conversation during his first anniversary trip to England, where a friend simplified film editing to merely cutting out 'bad bits.' Murch expresses his initial frustration but later acknowledges the truth in that perspective.

Defining 'Bad Bits'

Identifying 'bad bits' becomes complex in narrative filmmaking, unlike in home movies, where the criteria are straightforward. The editor's task is to determine what constitutes a 'bad bit' for a specific film while maintaining the integrity of the 'good bits.'

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The DNA Analogy

Drawing a parallel, Murch compares editing film to the genetic similarities between humans and chimpanzees. While DNA between the two species is 99% identical, the differences emerge through the activation and sequence of genetic information, akin to how a film editor chooses when and how to present certain footage.

The Role of the Editor

Murch posits that various editors could create different films from the same raw footage, influenced by their choices and the order of information revealed. For instance, revealing whether a gun is loaded before or after a critical moment changes the scene's impact significantly.

Unique Adaptations

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Chapter 4 Summary : Most with the Least

Summary of Chapter 4: In the Blink of an Eye

Challenges in Filmmaking

In this chapter, Walter Murch discusses difficulties faced in filmmaking, exemplified by projects like a chimpanzee film intended for human audiences, which ultimately failed to resonate as either. He touches upon another project, “Film Y,” that lost its nuanced vision due to studio pressures for more action and sensational content, resulting in a diluted narrative.

Maximizing Impact with Minimalism

Murch emphasizes the principle of achieving maximum effect with minimal resources. The quality of sound mixes cannot simply be assessed by the number of tracks; excellent mixes can stem from just a few well-chosen elements. The

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key is to engage the audience's imagination through suggestion rather than over-exposition. He argues that excessive detail can alienate viewers, shifting them from participants to mere spectators.

Application Across Filmmaking Crafts

This minimalist approach applies universally to all facets of filmmaking—acting, art direction, photography, music, costume design, and especially editing. Murch insists on the importance of focusing on essential elements to effectively convey emotions and stories.

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Chapter 5 Summary : The Rule of Six

Section	Details
Chapter Title	Summary of Chapter 5: The Rule of Six
Main Focus	Importance of deliberate cuts in film editing to enhance viewer engagement.
Key Insights	Editors should avoid cutting for the sake of cutting and feel confident in leaving moments intact to improve viewer experience.
Rule of Six	A hierarchy for evaluating cuts based on emotional and narrative effectiveness.
Criteria of the Rule of Six	Emotion: Evoke intended feelings. Story: Advance the narrative. Rhythm: Ensure natural timing and flow. Eye-trace: Maintain audience's focus within the frame. Planarity: Respect two-dimensional representation of three-dimensional actions. Three-dimensional continuity: Keep spatial relationships, though least critical.
Overall Argument	If a cut enhances emotion and story, minor rhythm or continuity issues are acceptable, promoting a seamless viewing experience.

Summary of Chapter 5: The Rule of Six

In this chapter, Walter Murch emphasizes the complexity of editing in film, focusing on the importance of making deliberate cuts that enhance the audience's experience rather than merely meeting a quota for cuts. An overzealous approach can hinder viewer engagement, similar to a tour guide who overwhelms guests with information instead of allowing them to absorb the moment.

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Key Points:

Deciding on Cuts

- Editors make numerous decisions rapidly and should refrain from cutting simply for the sake of it.
- Confidence in leaving moments uncut can enhance viewer experience.

The Rule of Six

Murch introduces the "Rule of Six," a hierarchy to evaluate cuts based on emotional impact and narrative progression:
1.
Emotion
: The primary factor; effective cuts should evoke the intended feelings.
2.
Story
: Cuts should serve to advance the narrative.
3.
Rhythm
: The timing and flow of the cut must feel natural.

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4.

Eye-trace

: Attention to the audience's focus within the frame is crucial.

5.

Planarity

: Respect the two-dimensional depiction of three-dimensional actions.

6.

Three-dimensional continuity

: Maintain spatial relationships, although this is the least critical of the six.

Murch argues that if a cut enhances emotion and story, minor issues with rhythm or continuity are permissible. Overall, the cut should prioritize what resonates emotionally with the audience while still supporting the film’s narrative integrity. The balance between these elements creates a seamless viewing experience that belies the technical complexities involved in editing.

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Example

Key Point:Understanding the Rule of Six enhances your editing skills.

Example:Imagine you're editing a pivotal scene in your short film where a character receives heartbreaking news. Instead of hastily cutting to ensure you meet a target number of edits, you pause and think: how can I make this moment resonate emotionally with the audience? You remember Murch's advice—it’s not just about how many cuts you make, but why you make them. So, you decide to linger a fraction longer on the actor’s pained expression, drawing out their realization and addressing the audience's emotional response directly. You can feel the shift in atmosphere as viewers hold their breath, connecting deeply with the character’s turmoil. This choice not only strengthens the story but showcases the power of deliberate editing. By following the Rule of Six, you’ve transformed a simple cut into a significant emotional moment—one that viewers won't soon forget.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The Hierarchy of Emotional Impact in Editing

Critical Interpretation:Murch’s ‘Rule of Six’ poignantly highlights how emotional resonance should dominate film editing decisions, suggesting that technical precision can sometimes yield to emotional storytelling. However, this perspective raises questions about the subjective experience of viewers, as emotion can be interpreted differently based on individual experiences and cultural contexts. Critics might argue that prioritizing emotional impact over technical aspects may lead to detracting from the film's narrative depth, posing a challenge to the universality of Murch's guidelines. Sources such as Bordwell and Thompson's 'Film Art: An Introduction' offer alternative frameworks emphasizing narrative over emotion, helping readers critically evaluate Murch’s assertion.

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Chapter 6 Summary : Misdirection

Key Principles of Film Editing
1. Emotion over story 2. Story over rhythm 3. Rhythm over eye-trace 4. Eye-trace over planarity 5. Planarity over spatial continuity
Editors anticipate audience thoughts and emotions, directing attention much like a magician uses misdirection to create engagement and wonder.
Balancing focus on intricate details and overarching narrative is crucial for effective editing.

Summary of Chapter 6 from "In the Blink of an Eye" by Walter Murch

Key Principles of Film Editing

In the process of editing, six critical criteria must be prioritized: emotion, story, rhythm, eye-trace, planarity, and spatial continuity. The top three (emotion, story, rhythm) are tightly interconnected, while the bonds weaken as you move down the list. Editors should strive to meet all six criteria, aiming to enhance the audience's experience.

Priorities in Editing

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When faced with the need to compromise, editors should prioritize the following hierarchy:

1. Emotion over story
2. Story over rhythm
3. Rhythm over eye-trace
4. Eye-trace over planarity
5. Planarity over spatial continuity

The Role of the Editor as a Magician

The central focus for film editors is to understand and anticipate the audience's thoughts and emotions. Editors must craft a viewing experience that guides the audience’s attention, much like a magician directs their audience's gaze. This “misdirection” is essential for creating engagement and wonder in the narrative.

Maintaining Perspective

While attention to detail is important, editors must not lose sight of the overarching narrative. Balancing the focus on both the intricate details and the overall story is crucial for effective editing.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The hierarchical prioritization of emotional impact in film editing reflects a subjective lens.

Critical Interpretation:Murch argues that emotion should precede story in editing prioritization, yet this approach invites scrutiny regarding its universality in artistic creation. Emotional resonance is undeniably powerful in storytelling, but its primacy may not suit all films or viewers. Critics like David Bordwell challenge the notion that emotion should always overshadow narrative clarity, suggesting that for certain genres or styles, story coherence may need equal or greater emphasis (Bordwell, 'Narration in the Fiction Film'). This conversation underscores the variability inherent in cinematic expression, urging readers to reconsider the absolutism in Murch's hierarchy.

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Chapter 7 Summary : Seeing Around the Edge of the Frame

Chapter 7 Summary: Seeing Around the Edge of the Frame

In this chapter, Walter Murch discusses the editor's role in achieving an objective perspective on a film. He emphasizes that editors should view the footage as an audience would, devoid of the emotional baggage tied to the shooting process. To foster this viewpoint, he suggests imagining oneself in a large theater, assessing the film without the ability to make changes.

Murch explores how familiarity with the set and conditions of shooting can cloud an editor's judgment. Directors, burdened with behind-the-scenes knowledge, may struggle to objectively evaluate the footage due to the costs associated with specific shots. To combat this, Murch recommends that directors take a break after shooting to clear their minds, allowing them to return to the editing room with a fresh outlook.

He highlights the importance of separating the experiences of

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shooting and editing, advocating for creators to focus solely on the images presented on screen. This approach helps editors discern which moments to retain and which to discard, irrespective of their emotional or financial implications during production. Ultimately, Murch urges for a mental barrier between the chaotic emotions of filming and the objective task of editing, enabling filmmakers to refine their work effectively.

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Example

Key Point:Objective perspective is vital for effective film editing.

Example:Imagine yourself sitting in a darkened theater, the flickering images on the screen captivating your attention. As you immerse yourself in the film, your mind is stripped of all the behind-the-scenes decisions about costs and set complications. You are not the editor burdened by emotional ties; you are simply a viewer. This fresh outlook allows you to assess the pacing, character development, and overall flow of the film critically, discerning which scenes truly resonate and which dilute the experience. The freedom from emotional baggage enables you to celebrate the artistry of the film in its truest form, reminding you that an editor's role is to serve the audience's experience above all else.

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Chapter 8 Summary : Dreaming in Pairs

Summary of Chapter 8: Dreaming in Pairs

Role of Film Editor and Director

In filmmaking, the relationship between the editor and the director parallels that of a text editor and a writer. The editor advises on the narrative direction and content decisions, while also assembling the visuals—akin to crafting words. This collaborative dynamic shifts throughout the project, with the roles sometimes reversing.

Dream Therapy as a Metaphor

Dream therapy employs a technique where a dreamer recounts their dreams to a listener soon after waking. The listener proposes interpretations or scenarios based on fragments of the dream, prompting the dreamer to clarify and expand upon their initial recollections. This process reveals deeper layers of the dream's meaning.

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Comparison to Film Editing

The editor acts like the listener in dream therapy, encouraging the director (the dreamer) to explore alternative scenarios that may unlock more insights into the film. This involves making decisions that affect both the overall story and the finer details of each shot, much like how the listener helps the dreamer uncover hidden elements of their dream.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The dynamic of collaboration between editor and director is crucial to film creation.

Critical Interpretation:Walter Murch draws a compelling parallel between the roles of film editor and director and the therapeutic act of dream interpretation, illustrating how both processes involve collaborative reinterpretation of narratives—whether in dreams or cinematic storytelling. However, while Murch's insights are valuable, one might argue that this comparison oversimplifies the complexities of film production, as roles in filmmaking can vary widely depending on individual styles and experiences. Critics like David Bordwell in 'Film Art: An Introduction' may contend that the collaborative process can be less about metaphorical dreaming and more about practical negotiations and decision-making that do not always align with dream narrative dynamics.

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Chapter 9 Summary : Team Work:Multiple Editors

Summary of Chapter 9: Team Work: Multiple Editors

The Role of Editors and Collaboration

In film editing, the relationship between editors and directors can vary, with editors sometimes embodying the dreamer role and directors acting as listeners. The success of this collaboration often hinges on the quality of ideas presented by the director, similar to how the right bait attracts specific fish.

The Need for Multiple Editors

There are instances when multiple editors work together on a project, which is less common for roles like directors of photography. The collaborative approach of editors, coupled

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with the need for speed in post-production, makes employing multiple editors advantageous. This strategy can be essential when handling extensive footage, such as in films that require over 350,000 feet of workprint.

Challenges of a Single Editor

Having a single editor can lead to a "locked viewpoint," which is problematic if they and the director lack prior collaboration. The experience with "The Godfather" taught that bringing in multiple editors can alleviate such issues, especially under tight deadlines where rapid progress is necessary.

Case Studies in Editing

In "The Godfather," the initial editor was replaced due to the locked viewpoint issue, resulting in a decision to hire two

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Chapter 10 Summary : The Decisive Moment

The Decisive Moment

Overview of the Editing Process

While Phil Kaufman filmed *The Unbearable Lightness of Being* in France, Walter Murch edited it from Berkeley, California. Murch received dailies every two weeks, which required him to watch considerable footage and prepare for discussion with the director.

Photography in Editing

Murch implemented a unique method by selecting representative frames from every camera setup and capturing them as photographs. These photos were developed and organized onto panels by scene, facilitating discussions with the director and serving as a visual record of details beyond typical continuity notes, including actors' expressions and

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costume specifics.

Panel Layout and Interpretation

The photographs were arranged in a book-like format, allowing visual cross-referencing of character emotions, costumes, and settings. Juxtaposing the panels often sparked new ideas and editorial insights, making these images an essential part of the editing process.

Emotional Language through Photography

Murch emphasized the significance of these photos as a "language of emotions," illustrating complex feelings that words might fail to convey. The editor’s challenge was to select the right images that expressed these nuanced emotions and arrange them effectively in the sequence.

The Importance of Selection

Choosing a representative frame is pivotal; it captures the essence of the entire shot, embodying what Cartier-Bresson describes as the "decisive moment." Each shot during dailies acts as an audition, and Murch stressed the importance of

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maintaining sharp awareness to appreciate the richness of each take while avoiding mental fatigue.

Conclusion

Through careful selection, photography, and interpretation, Murch navigated the complexities of editing, aiming to produce a film that resonated with deep emotional truths, ultimately preserving the nuances captured in the "decisive moments."

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Example

Key Point:The importance of the decisive moment in editing to convey emotional depth in film.

Example:Imagine you are piecing together your own story through a series of photographs from a family gathering. As you sift through countless images, each one evokes a memory, a laugh, or a tear. You realize that selecting a single photograph—perhaps of your grandmother's warm smile as she clinks glasses with your grandfather—can encapsulate the love and joy of the entire event. The challenge lies in recognizing that each image holds a particular essence, a moment that resonates emotionally. Just like how Murch approaches film editing, every photograph needs to be assessed for its emotional weight, ensuring that the chosen image not only stands alone but also captures the spirit of that day, much like how film frames must work together to create a powerful narrative.

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Chapter 11 Summary : Methods and Machines:
Marble and Clay

Section	Summary
Overview of Editing Systems	The choice of editing tools significantly influences the final product, with various machines from Moviola to digital systems impacting how editors interact with footage.
Comparison of Editing Techniques	Murch contrasts the Moviola (clay-like method) for individualized shot manipulation with the KEM (marble-like method) for organic discovery, preferring the latter for its linearity that inspires unexpected insights.
Engaging with Dailies	Reviewing dailies multiple times is crucial for editors, as initial perceptions may obscure potential strengths which can be revealed upon revisiting the material.
Creative Process and Intuition	The ideal editing moment occurs when the film's narrative takes precedence over the editor's influence, creating a transformative experience.
Challenges with Color Correction	Murch expresses frustration with color correction, highlighting issues with viewing conditions and screenings, recommending low-light syncing of workprints with answer prints for better evaluation.
Conclusion	Murch advocates for a balance between structure and chaos in editing, stressing the need for adaptability in the creative process to harness both spontaneity and clarity.

Summary of Chapter 11: Methods and Machines: Marble and Clay

Overview of Editing Systems

In the editing process, the choice of tools influences the final product. The author reflects on his experiences with various editing machines, from the traditional Moviola to modern

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digital systems like Avid and Lightworks. Each machine offers a different approach to editing, shaping how the editor interacts with the footage.

Comparison of Editing Techniques

Murch contrasts two editing approaches:

- **Moviola** (clay-like method): Breaks down film into individual shots, allowing the editor to "sculpt" by rearranging pieces.
- **KEM** (marble-like method): Maintains film in long rolls, aiding in a more organic discovery process. He prefers the KEM for its linear nature, which prompts unexpected insights as the editor searches through footage.

Engaging with Dailies

Murch emphasizes the importance of reviewing dailies multiple times to evolve as an editor, enabling the recognition of previously overlooked possibilities. Initial impressions can be misleading, so returning to the material

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later often reveals its strengths.

Creative Process and Intuition

The ideal moment in editing is when the editor's presence fades and the film begins to convey its own narrative. Murch describes this as a transformative experience where scenes feel self-created rather than dictated by the editor.

Challenges with Color Correction

Murch shares frustrations regarding color correction in laboratories, noting issues with viewing conditions and the quick pace of screenings. He recommends syncing workprints with answer prints in low light for better evaluation of tonalities.

Conclusion

Ultimately, Murch believes in the balance between structured and chaotic elements in editing systems. The evolving nature of film necessitates a flexible approach that accommodates both spontaneity and clarity in the creative process.

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Chapter 12 Summary : Test Screenings: Referred Pain

Test Screenings: Referred Pain

Audience Participation in Film Editing

Fred Zinnemann believed that the last ten percent of a film's completion relies on audience feedback, highlighting the collaborative nature of filmmaking. Although directors and editors spend considerable time with the material, it's the audience that can identify blind spots and provide necessary corrections to avoid obsession with particular elements.

Testing Approach Variations

Francis Coppola favored early and rough screenings with a mix of familiar and unfamiliar viewers to gauge reactions. In contrast, Zinnemann chose to present a fully finished film before involving audiences, believing that any technical imperfections would skew feedback. Despite the utility of

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test screenings, the interpretations of audience reactions must be approached with caution.

Emotional Insights from Screenings

The emotional experience of screening a film before a live audience can reveal previously unnoticed aspects. It shifts the perspective from an insider's view to an external one, highlighting strengths and weaknesses that may need addressing.

Understanding Audience Feedback

Test screenings serve as a navigational tool, revealing where the film stands rather than directly indicating what fixes are needed. Insights should be drawn from audience reactions over time, rather than immediate responses, to avoid misdiagnosing issues based on "referred pain."

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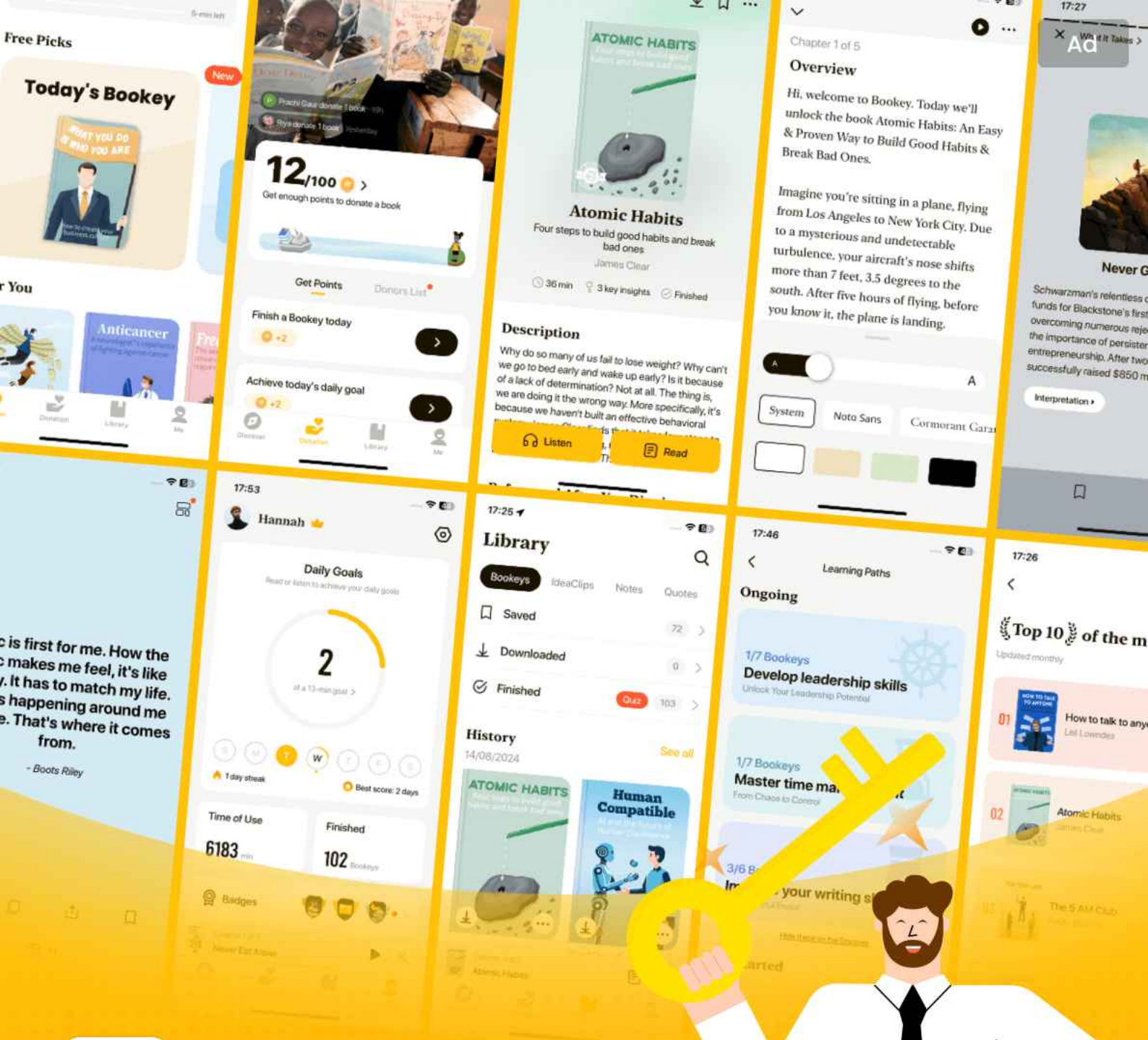
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Chapter 13 Summary : Don't Worry,It's Only a Movie

Summary of Chapter 13 - In the Blink of an Eye

Editing Decisions and Emotional Impact

The chapter discusses the emotional and intuitive nature involved in film editing. Walter Murch references a scene he decided to cut from a film, reflecting on the anxiety that comes with such choices, akin to the dread of cutting off an essential connection. He argues that the cut can sometimes free the film to resonate more deeply, much like an umbilical cord being severed once its purpose is fulfilled.

The Art and Violence of Cuts

Murch describes the act of cutting film as a brutal yet transformative process. Although there is a violent discontinuity in cutting, it results in the creation of art

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imbued with life and soul. He contrasts this abruptness with the continuous nature of real-life perception, suggesting that the cuts in film may mirror the sudden shifts found in dreams.

Dreams and Visual Discontinuity

The connection between film cuts and dream-like imagery is explored. Murch posits that the disjointed transitions in dreams prepare viewers for the cuts in films, making them feel familiar despite their apparent strangeness. He notes that comfort phrases used for nightmares are also relevant to films, highlighting the emotional similarity between dreams and cinematic experiences.

Observations of Human Perception

Murch shares insights from his early experience editing 'The Conversation,' revealing how human blinking may serve as a physiological mechanism for processing thought and distorting continuous visuals into discrete ideas. The blink is seen as a natural cut in perception, paralleling the cuts made in film.

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Blinking as a Reflection of Thought

The author further examines the patterns of blinking in relation to emotional states and cognitive processing. He suggests that blinking occurs precisely when an idea is grasped or when a speaker concludes a significant point, thus creating a "cut" similar to those seen in film. He advocates that these natural, filmic juxtapositions help to organize and make sense of reality.

Conclusion: The Familiarity of Filmic Juxtapositions

Murch concludes that visual discontinuities in both waking life and dreams require our brains to punctuate and structure perceived reality. The familiarity of cuts in film mirrors the innate ways our minds process information, making the experience of watching edited film surprisingly akin to our thought processes.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The intimate relationship between film cuts and human perception reveals deeper cognitive mechanisms.

Critical Interpretation:Murch's exploration of how editing mimics the natural 'cuts' associated with human cognition invites readers to question the premise that emotional editing decisions always lead to superior narrative depth. While Murch argues that such cuts are essential for creating impactful art, it is important to scrutinize whether the effectiveness of these cinematic choices is universal or if it may vary based on individual perception and experience. Neuropsychological research, such as that presented in works like 'Thinking, Fast and Slow' by Daniel Kahneman, highlights the diversity in human cognitive processing, suggesting that not all viewers may resonate equally with Murch's theories on emotional cuts. This prompts a broader inquiry into how personal experiences shape one’s interpretation of art, raising the question of whether a more nuanced understanding of viewer psychology could refute Murch’s singular vision on the emotional power of cuts.

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Chapter 14 Summary : Dragnet

Chapter 14: Dragnet

The Role of Blinking in Acting and Editing

The rhythm of an actor's blinking is closely tied to their inner emotions and thoughts, providing insights into their character. A successful actor's blinks align with their character's emotional rhythm, which is essential for effective editing. Noticing where an actor blinks can help editors identify cut points that reflect real-life conversational dynamics.

Editing Techniques: The "Dragnet" System

The "Dragnet" editing style, characterized by its simplistic approach of cutting between speakers without regard for emotional nuance, fails to capture the complexity of real conversations. This method relies on a formulaic approach that does not reflect the rhythmic ebb and flow of dialogue.

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Identifying Cut Points

When editing, it's critical to determine potential cut points that align with the audience's cognitive and emotional responses. Editors can guide viewer perception by choosing when to cut away from a character, thereby influencing the audience's understanding of the narrative. Identifying these cut points can resemble the natural rhythm of human blinking during conversation.

Balancing Editing Pace

Effective pacing within a film should mimic real-life blinking rates—higher during fast-paced actions and lower during dialogue. Editors must lead the audience's attention through careful cut choices, either increasing the number of cuts during intense scenes or reducing them to cultivate a sense of objectivity.

Anticipating Audience Reactions

Editors must anticipate the audience's needs, guiding their emotional and cognitive engagement. The goal is to create a seamless flow that feels both natural and exciting, aligning closely with the audience's expectations and reactions.

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Chapter 15 Summary : A Galaxy of Winking Dots

Summary of Chapter 15: A Galaxy of Winking Dots

Audience Engagement and Blinking Patterns

Walter Murch proposes exploring the patterns of audience blinking through infrared film while watching movies. He hypothesizes that when an audience is engrossed in a film, their blinking will synchronize with the rhythm of the movie.

Infrared Imagery and Audience Perception

The effect of shining infrared light along the lens of a camera reveals animal eyes—including human eyes—as bright dots in a dark field. This technique could capture the momentary interruption of these dots when audience members blink, potentially indicating collective engagement with the film.

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Indicators of Engagement

Murch suggests that consistent blinking among viewers would signal that the film is effectively resonating with the audience. Conversely, scattered blinking might reveal distraction, indicating that the audience's thoughts have shifted away from the film.

Coughing and Suppression of Responses

He draws parallels between blinking and coughing, noting that audiences often suppress coughing during key moments in performances or films. This phenomenon was highlighted during a live performance by pianist Sviatoslav Richter, where the audience refrained from coughing during impactful passages, demonstrating the power of art in maintaining attention.

Subconscious Communication through Blinking

Murch emphasizes that blinking can serve as a subconscious cue in everyday interactions, where variations in blinking can influence feelings of comfort or discomfort regarding another person's attentiveness and engagement in conversation.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The Synchronization of Blinking and Engagement

Critical Interpretation:Walter Murch's proposition that audience blinking synchronizes with film rhythm may appear insightful, suggesting a profound connection between viewer engagement and physiological responses. However, while these ideas spark intriguing discussions about collective experience, it is important to question their validity. The impact of individual viewer's emotional and psychological states on their physical reactions could vary greatly; some may blink frequently out of anxiety or distraction unrelated to the film's rhythm. Furthermore, while Murch cites interesting observational techniques, such as those involving infrared technology, such methods have limitations and do not universally apply to diverse audience reactions. For deeper understanding, one might refer to studies on audience engagement and physiological responses in media, such as

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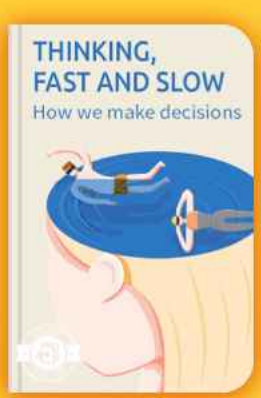
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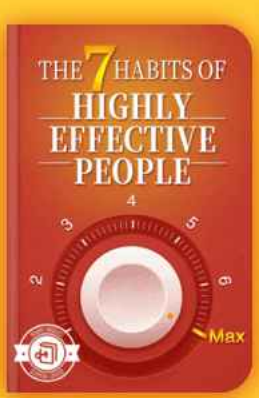
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Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 7-8

1. it is frequently at the edges of things that we learn most about the middle: ice and steam can reveal more about the nature of water than water alone ever could.
2. One of the reasons for that length was simply the amount of film that had been printed: 1,250,000 feet, which works out to be just over 230 hours.
3. I sat down and figured out the total number of days that we (the editors) had worked, divided that number by the number of cuts that were in the finished product, and came up with the rate of cuts per editor per day- which turned out to be... 1.47!
4. if we had somehow known exactly where we were going at the beginning, we would have arrived there in the same number of months if each of us had made just under

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one-and-a-half splices per day.

Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 9-11

1. The overwhelming majority of an editor's time is not spent actually splicing film.
2. The joining of those pieces - the 'cut'... represents a total and instantaneous displacement of one field of vision with another.
3. Discontinuity is King: It is the central fact during the production phase of filmmaking.
4. Even if everything were available simultaneously, it is just very difficult to shoot long, continuous takes and have all the contributing elements work each time.
5. Cutting is more than just the convenient means by which discontinuity is rendered continuous.

Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 12-13

1. What makes a bad bit?
2. ....editing is structure, color, dynamics, manipulation of time, all of these other things, etc., etc.
3. One way of looking at the process of making a film is to

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think of it as the search to identify what—for the particular film you are working on—is a uniquely 'bad bit.'

4. I’m not assigning relative values here to a chimpanzee or a human being. Let’s just say that each is appropriate to the environment in which it belongs.
5. Don't start making a chimpanzee and then decide to turn it into a human being instead.

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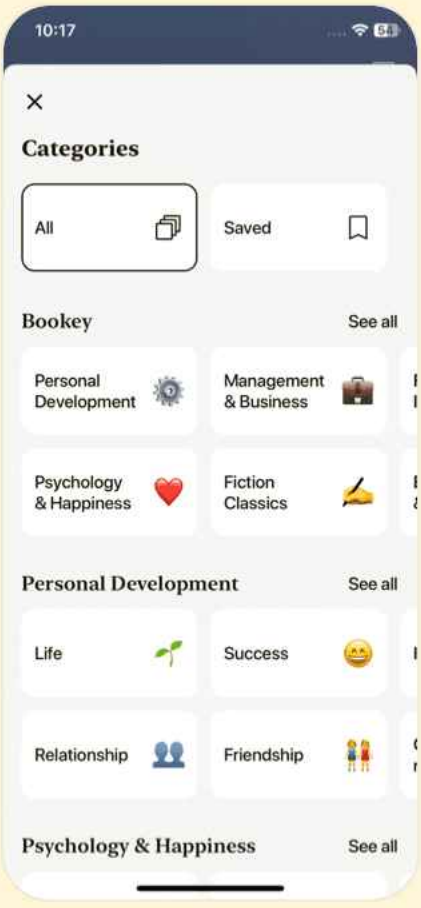
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Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 14-14

1. You can never judge the quality of a sound mix simply by counting the number of tracks it took to produce it.
2. Always try to do the most with the least—with the emphasis on try.
3. You want to do only what is necessary to engage the imagination of the audience—suggestion is always more effective than exposition.
4. Past a certain point, the more effort you put into wealth of detail, the more you encourage the audience to become spectators rather than participants.
5. The same principle applies to all the various crafts of filmmaking: acting, art direction, photography, music, costume, etc.

Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 15-16

1. Frequently, it takes more work and discernment to decide where not to cut—don't feel you have to cut just because you are being paid to.

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2.If the guide—that is to say, the editor—doesn't have the confidence to let people themselves occasionally choose what they want to look at, or to leave things to their imagination, then he is pursuing a goal (complete control) that in the end is self-defeating.

3.How do you want the audience to feel? If they are feeling what you want them to feel all the way through the film, you've done about as much as you can ever do.

4.Emotion, at the top of the list, is the thing that you should try to preserve at all costs.

5.If you find you have to sacrifice certain of those six things to make a cut, sacrifice your way up, item by item, from the bottom.

6.The general principle seems to be that satisfying the criteria of items higher on the list tends to obscure problems with items lower on the list, but not vice-versa.

Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 17-17

1.Never accept less when more is available to you.

2.Don't ever give up emotion before story. Don't give up

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story before rhythm, don't give up rhythm before eye-trace, don't give up eye-trace before planarity and don't give up planarity before spatial continuity.

3. If you keep this in mind (and it's the preoccupation of every magician), then you are a kind of magician.
4. Houdini's job was to create a sense of wonder, and to do that he didn't want you to look there (to the right) because that's where he was undoing his chains... He was doing something that would cause ninety-nine percent of you to look over here when he wanted you to.
5. Sometimes, though you can get caught up in the details and lose track of the overview.

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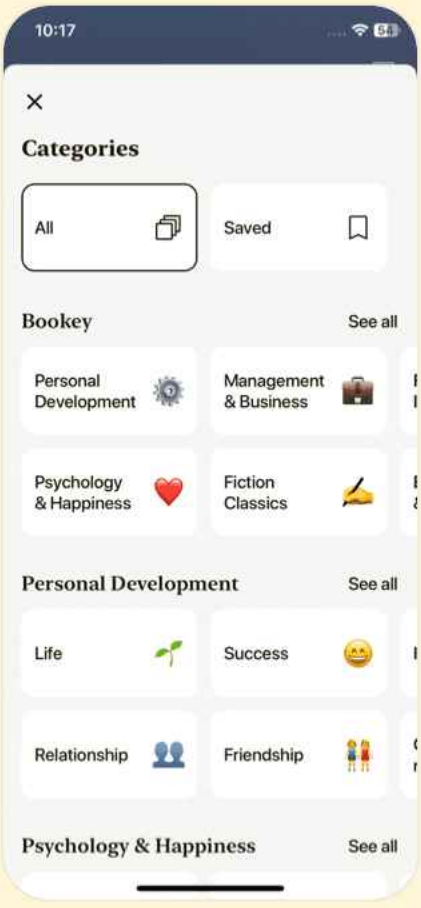
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Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 18-19

1. If you still like what you see, it is probably okay. If not, you will now most likely have a better idea of how to correct the problem, whatever it is.
2. The editor, on the other hand, should try to see only what's on the screen, as the audience will. Only in this way can the images be freed from the context of their creation.
3. Do everything you can to help the director erect this barrier for himself so that when he first sees the film, he can say, 'All right, I'm going to pretend that I had nothing to do with this film.'
4. Then, after a few weeks, he would come down from the Alps, back to earth; he would sit down in a dark room, alone, the arc light would ignite, and he would watch his film.

Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 20-20

1. the film editor performs the same role /for the director as the text editor does for the writer
2. the director is generally the dreamer and the editor is the

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3.the editor's job to propose alternate scenarios as bait

4.the dream itself, hidden in the memory, rises to its own defense

5.encourage the sleeping dream to rise to its defense and thus reveal itself more fully

Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 21-22

1. It is the editor who is the dreamer and the director who is the listener, and it is he who now offers the bait to tempt the collective dream to reveal more of itself.

2.The main advantage to collaborative editing is speed; the main risk is lack of coherence.

3.If you end up with a cut-per-day rate of 1.47, as we did on Apocalypse, that means that many different avenues have been explored to get to the final product.

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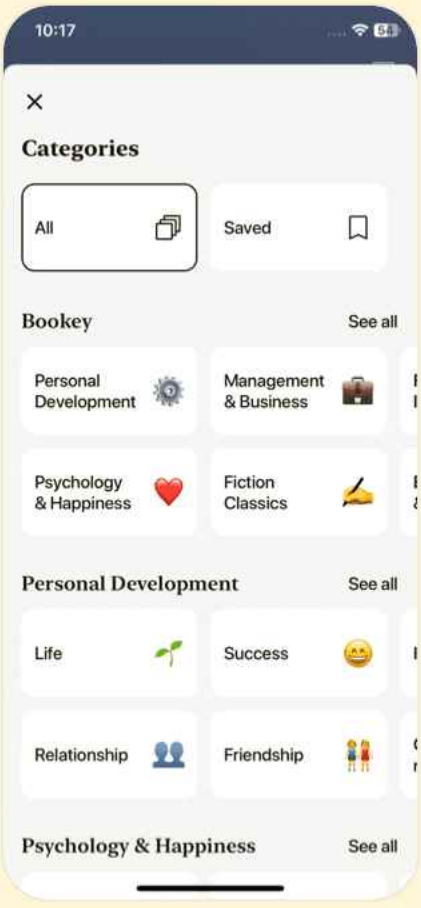
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Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 23-27

1. What word expresses the concept of ironic anger tinged with melancholy? There isn't a word for it, in English anyway, but you can see that specific emotion represented in this photograph.
2. So I think, more often than not, the image that I chose wound up in the film. And also, more often than not, quite close to the cut point.
3. Whatever it means, it is there in her expression, in the angle of her head and her hair and her neck and the tension in the muscles and the set of her mouth and what is in her eyes.
4. The editor's job now is to choose the right images and make those images follow one another at the right rate to express something like what is captured in that photograph.
5. Each shot is auditioning for your approval. Take five: 'How about me? I can do this.' Then take seven comes in the door: 'How about this?'

Chapter 11 | Quotes From Pages 28-32

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1. What this photo system does is just tip you up out of your chair a bit. It is an encouragement to do what you should be doing anyway. And it is the beginning of the editorial process.
2. Editing is a kind of surgery—and have you ever seen a surgeon sitting to perform an operation?
3. with the KEM system, because the film is all stored in these big rolls in an almost arbitrary way, you are learning something new about the material as you search for what you think you want.
4. Sometimes—the best times—this process reaches the point where I can look at the scene and say, 'I didn't have anything to do with that—it just created itself.'

Chapter 12 | Quotes From Pages 33-34

1. The participation of the audience...could only go ninety percent of the way toward the finished film—that what was needed for the last ten percent was "the participation of the audience.
2. It's as if up to this moment you have been constructing a

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building but always standing in front of it to evaluate it. Now all of a sudden you are looking at the side of the building and seeing things you seem to have never seen before.

3. When you go to a doctor and tell him that you have a pain in your elbow, it is the quack who takes out his scalpel and starts to operate on the elbow. Then you wind up with not only the original pain but probably a pain in your wrist and your shoulder as well.
4. If you are going to do previews and listen to what people have to say, that's the way to do it—after they have had a day or two to let the film sink in.
5. Editing decisions become particularly acute in the last days before the film is released, since changes made now will be permanent.

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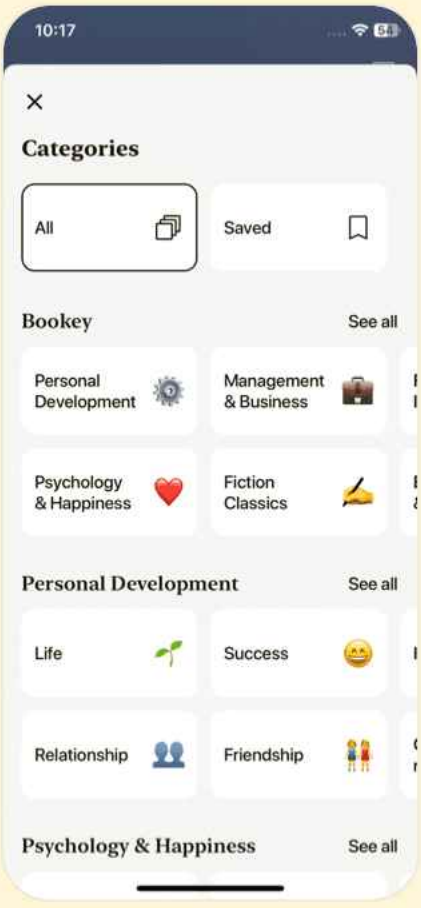
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Chapter 13 | Quotes From Pages 35-38

1. You know, when I first read this scene in the script, I knew that I could do this film.
2. In or Out! We chop up the poor film in a miniature guillotine and then stick the dismembered pieces together like Dr. Frankenstein's monster.
3. The blink signals the moment he relinquished his primary thought.
4. It is important to emphasize that the cut by itself does not create the 'blink moment'—the tail does not wag the dog.
5. We must render visual reality discontinuous; otherwise, perceived reality would resemble an almost incomprehensible string of letters without word separation or punctuation.

Chapter 14 | Quotes From Pages 39-41

1. ...rates and rhythms of blinking refer directly to the rhythm and sequence of our inner emotions and thoughts, then those rates and rhythms are insights into our inner selves and, therefore, as

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characteristic of each of us as our signatures.

2. If an actor is successful at projecting himself into the emotions and thoughts of a character, his blinks will naturally and spontaneously occur at the point that the character's blinks would have occurred in real life.
3. The 'Dragnet' system is a simple way to edit, but it is a shallow simplicity that doesn't reflect the grammar of complex exchanges that go on all the time in even the most ordinary conversations.
4. You should be right with the blinks, perhaps leading them ever so slightly. I certainly don't expect the audience to blink at every cut—the cut point should be a potential blink point.
5. Your job is partly to anticipate, partly to control the thought processes of the audience. To give them what they want and/or what they need just before they have to 'ask' for it—to be surprising yet self-evident at the same time.

Chapter 15 | Quotes From Pages 42-42

1. If an audience is really in the grip of a film, they

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are going to be thinking (and therefore blinking) with the rhythm of the film.

2. Coherent blinking would be a strong indication that the audience was thinking together, and that the film was working.

3. When people are deeply 'in' a film, you'll notice that nobody coughs at certain moments, even though they may have a cold.

4. While he was playing certain passages, no one coughed. At those moments, he was able to suppress, with his artistry, the coughing impulse of 1,500 sick people.

5. One thing that may make you nervous about a particular person is that you feel, without knowing it, that his blinking is wrong.

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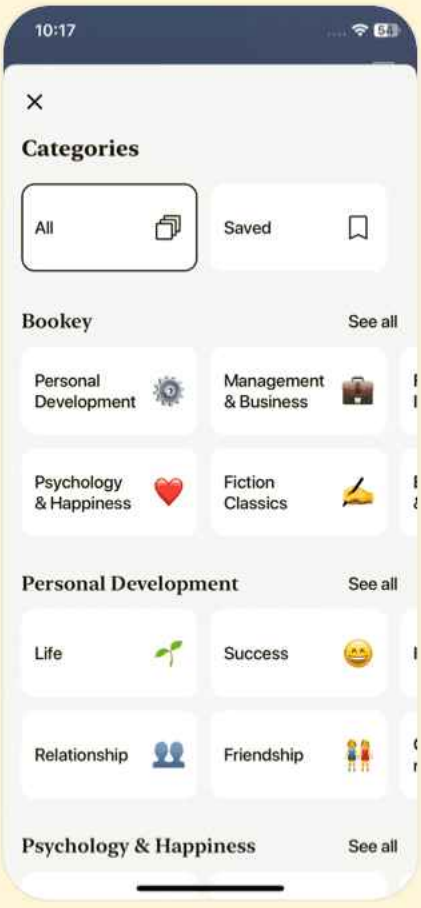
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In the Blink of an Eye Questions

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Chapter 1 | Cuts and Shadow Cuts| Q&A

1.Question

What are some methods Walter Murch describes for coping with the challenges of film editing?

Answer:Murch reflects on his own journey and experiences throughout his editing career, noting that his struggles and methods may serve as cautionary notes for himself. He emphasizes the importance of maintaining balance amid chaos, drawing insights from both the technical and creative aspects of filmmaking.

2.Question

How does Murch characterize the process of editing a film like 'Apocalypse Now'?

Answer:He explains that the process is akin to navigating a vast landscape, with periods of overwhelming material followed by stretches of minimal coverage. The editing of

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'Apocalypse Now' involved an extraordinarily high ratio of raw footage to final product, illustrating the complexity and labor-intensive nature of the editing process.

3.Question

What insights does Murch provide about the relationship between film footage and the editing process?

Answer:Murch highlights that for every minute of finished film, there can be vast quantities of unseen footage; for 'Apocalypse Now', it was ninety-five unseen minutes for each minute in the final cut. This speaks to the depth of footage filmmakers capture and the meticulous decision-making involved in editing.

4.Question

What does Murch mean when he refers to the challenges of 'normal' editing?

Answer:He indicates that even in a 'normal' film, the editing process is often far from straightforward. He offers statistics from 'Apocalypse Now' to illustrate that understanding the creative direction is crucial; it suggests that meticulous and

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careful planning can significantly streamline the editing journey.

5.Question

In what ways does Murch suggest that the act of editing can reveal deeper truths about filmmaking?

Answer:Murch notes that areas of high and low coverage in films often reflect the broader artistic choices behind the camera. He suggests that the most basic elements of footage, such as events captured spontaneously, can reveal deeper insights—just as learning about water can be enhanced by understanding ice and steam.

6.Question

Why does Walter Murch consider 'Apocalypse Now' an exceptional case in terms of post-production length and process?

Answer:The film required unprecedented time in post-production due to its extensive footage and ambitious creative vision. Murch's analysis, including the staggering ratio of captured footage to the final product, showcases how the demands of the film-making process can lead to

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extraordinary outcomes and revelations.

7.Question

What does Murch convey about the importance of collaborative effort and audience engagement in filmmaking?

Answer:Murch emphasizes gratitude towards his collaborators and the audience throughout his lectures and writings. He believes that communication and interaction between filmmakers and their viewers enrich the creative process, fostering a deeper understanding of the art.

8.Question

How does Murch's experience reflect the ongoing evolution of film editing technology and practices?

Answer:He alludes to the impact of non-linear and digital editing technologies, suggesting these advancements have transformed traditional methods. Reflecting on his experiences, Murch indicates that technology continues to reshape the dynamics of film editing, challenging older notions and inspiring new approaches.

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Chapter 2 | Why Do Cuts Work?| Q&A

1.Question

What is the main job of a film editor according to Murch?

Answer:The primary role of a film editor, as conveyed by Murch, is to discover and navigate the pathways of the narrative rather than merely cutting and splicing film. An editor spends a significant portion of their time on preparation activities including screenings, discussions, and deliberative thought, which ultimately lead to the decisive moment of cutting.

2.Question

How does Murch explain the process of cuts in film editing?

Answer:Murch explains that each cut in film editing represents an instantaneous transition from one visual context to another. This sudden displacement forces viewers to re-evaluate the new image within a different context, which

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is a skill we have surprisingly adapted to despite our natural tendency towards continuous visual experience.

3.Question

What practical challenges come with the technique of continuity in shooting?

Answer:Murch describes several logistical challenges associated with continuity, stating that coordinating complex shots can lead to increased chances of mistakes, such as actors forgetting their lines or technical issues, requiring lengthy reshoots. This is one reason filmmakers often embrace discontinuity.

4.Question

Why are cuts considered a positive influence in film creation?

Answer:Cuts are viewed as a positive influence because they engage the audience's perception by introducing sudden changes that create an emotional impact, even outside their practical necessity. They allow for a more dynamic storytelling experience by providing the director with the

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ability to choose the most effective camera angles for each narrative point.

5.Question

What does Murch mean by 'discontinuity is king'?

Answer:By stating 'discontinuity is king', Murch highlights the central role of discontinuous editing in filmmaking, asserting that it effectively shapes how stories are constructed and perceived, overriding the limitations of traditional, continuous shooting methods.

6.Question

How does Murch relate film editing to ancient Egyptian painting?

Answer:Murch draws a parallel between film cutting and ancient Egyptian painting, where discontinuous perspectives create a unique representation of the human figure. He suggests that as our films seem normal today, future perceptions of our editing styles may appear equally odd or 'comic' due to their fragmented nature.

7.Question

What paradox does Murch identify regarding cuts in

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film?

Answer:Murch identifies a paradox in that while cuts serve as a practical means of creating discontinuity, they are also inherently valuable in and of themselves as they contribute positively to the creative process of filmmaking and narrative engagement.

8.Question

What metaphor does Murch use to explain why cuts in film work?

Answer:Murch likens the effectiveness of cuts in film to the flight of bumblebees, which, despite seeming impossible according to the laws of physics, manage to fly. This illustrates the mysterious and seemingly illogical effectiveness of cuts in engaging viewers, prompting further exploration into understanding their function.

Chapter 3 | "Cut Out the Bad Bits"| Q&A

1.Question

What is the main insight offered by the comparison between film editing and biological development?

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Answer:The main insight is that both film editing and biological development involve a process of selection and prioritization. Just as an editor cuts out 'bad bits' to shape a narrative, the biological sequences in DNA determine how and when certain traits develop, emphasizing the importance of context and environment in both areas.

2.Question

How does the concept of 'cutting out bad bits' apply to personal growth or life experiences?

Answer:In personal growth, we can think of 'cutting out bad bits' as the process of assessing our experiences, identifying negative or unproductive elements, and learning from them. This selective reflection helps us shape our own narratives and better understand our identities, just as an editor shapes a film.

3.Question

What does Murch suggest about the value of the 'bad bits' in a film?

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Answer:Murch suggests that while certain elements might initially seem 'bad,' they may hold value depending on the context of the film. This reflects a deeper truth in life: what might appear negative can sometimes contribute positively to a larger narrative or lesson.

4.Question

How does Murch's narrative connect the ideas of structure and sequencing with creativity?

Answer:Murch connects structure and sequencing in film editing to creativity by suggesting that it takes a delicate balance to construct a meaningful message. The choices editors make about what to include and the sequence in which to present information directly influence the audience's understanding and emotional engagement, similar to how life's circumstances unfold.

5.Question

In what way does Murch differentiate between humans and chimpanzees in terms of development?

Answer:Murch emphasizes that humans and chimpanzees

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share similar DNA yet develop differently due to priorities in their growth sequences. Humans prioritize brain development over skull formation, indicating a different evolutionary adaptation focused on cognitive capabilities, while chimpanzees prioritize physical development for survival.

6.Question

What caution does Murch provide about changing direction during a creative process?

Answer:Murch warns against the risks of shifting direction partway through a creative project. He uses the analogy of not starting with one concept (like creating a chimpanzee) and then attempting to change it into something entirely different (like a human). This results in a disjointed and incoherent final product, akin to an editing mess in film.

7.Question

How does this chapter challenge our understanding of 'bad bits' in films and life?

Answer:This chapter challenges our understanding by suggesting that what we often label as 'bad bits' might

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actually be essential parts of a larger narrative. It encourages us to reconsider how we evaluate our experiences and the narratives we create from them.

8.Question

What key lesson can be drawn from Murch’s exploration of editing and biological development?

Answer:A key lesson is that both editing and life's processes are about making thoughtful choices. The value lies not just in cutting away, but in understanding how each piece contributes to the overall story or development.

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Chapter 4 | Most with the Least| Q&A

1.Question

What does Walter Murch mean by 'doing the most with the least' in filmmaking?

Answer:Walter Murch emphasizes the idea of simplicity and efficiency in filmmaking. He suggests that instead of overwhelming the audience with excessive details or layers, filmmakers should focus on making powerful choices with minimal elements. This approach allows for a more profound emotional engagement with the audience, as subtlety and suggestion often resonate more than overt exposition.

2.Question

How can the quality of a sound mix be assessed according to this text?

Answer:The quality of a sound mix cannot be judged solely on the number of tracks used. Murch highlights that both bad and good mixes can come from varying track counts. What

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matters more is the initial choices made, the quality of the sounds, and how effectively those sounds combine to evoke emotions in the audience.

3.Question

Why is suggestion more effective than exposition in engaging the audience?

Answer:Suggestion is more effective because it invites the audience to participate actively in the storytelling process. When filmmakers provide too much exposition, they risk making the audience passive spectators rather than engaged participants. By implying ideas and emotions rather than outright stating them, filmmakers tap into the audience's imagination, creating a more immersive experience.

4.Question

What lesson can be drawn from the examples of the chimpanzee film and film 'Y'?

Answer:The lesson is that ambitious projects can falter if they lose their original vision due to external pressures or unnecessary additions. Both films serve as cautionary tales

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about the importance of staying true to the core message and emotional depth of a story, rather than compromising it for marketability or sensationalism.

5.Question

How does this principle apply to editing specifically?

Answer:In editing, the principle of doing the most with the least translates to making concise and impactful cuts that serve the narrative without unnecessary distraction. Effective editing should enhance the story by highlighting key moments and emotions rather than overwhelming the viewer with excessive content.

6.Question

What is the overarching principle in filmmaking as described in this chapter?

Answer:The overarching principle is to strive for clarity and emotional resonance through minimalism. Filmmakers should focus on the essence of a scene by selecting only the most necessary elements to convey their message, thus encouraging audience engagement and imagination.

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Chapter 5 | The Rule of Six| Q&A

1.Question

What does Walter Murch suggest is at the core of effective editing?

Answer:At the core of effective editing, Walter Murch emphasizes the importance of emotion. He argues that the audience's feelings are what they will remember most about a film, transcending the technical aspects of editing, camerawork, or even the storyline.

2.Question

How does Murch explain the importance of cuts in film editing?

Answer:Murch explains that every cut in filmmaking represents a decision—a moment where the editor must decide whether to continue a shot or switch to another. This process is akin to being a guide who should allow viewers the space to engage with the film, rather than overwhelming them with constant direction.

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3.Question

What is the 'Rule of Six' that Murch refers to in assessing cuts?

Answer:The 'Rule of Six' is a hierarchy Murch establishes for evaluating cuts in a film, which includes: 1) Emotion, 2) Story advancement, 3) Rhythm of the cut, 4) Eye-trace of the audience, 5) Respect for the two-dimensional plane of the screen, and 6) Respect for three-dimensional continuity of the space.

4.Question

Why does Murch prioritize emotion over other criteria in editing?

Answer:Murch prioritizes emotion because he believes it is the most impactful element; if the emotion is effective, audiences are likely to overlook flaws in other areas like spatial continuity or eye-trace. In essence, a strong emotional connection can overshadow technical editing issues.

5.Question

How can editors balance between maintaining spatial continuity and emotional impact in cuts?

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Answer:Editors should prioritize cuts that preserve emotional integrity and story progression. If a cut contributes positively to the emotion and narrative flow, even at the cost of spatial continuity, then it is justified. Murch advises sacrificing lower-order criteria (like three-dimensional space) in favor of higher-priority aspects (like emotion and story).

6.Question

What does Murch mean by 'eye-trace' in editing?

Answer:'Eye-trace' refers to the editor's consideration of the viewer's attention and focus within the frame. Good editing should guide the audience's gaze in a way that feels natural and enhances understanding of the scene.

7.Question

What insights can be drawn about the role of the editor in shaping viewer experience?

Answer:The editor plays a crucial role in shaping how viewers perceive and emotionally engage with a film. By making thoughtful decisions that enhance emotional resonance, the editor can elevate the overall impact of the

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film, ensuring that the audience feels connected to the narrative.

8.Question

What does Murch suggest about the decision-making process in editing?

Answer:Murch suggests that the editor's decision-making process is akin to navigating a complex landscape, where each cut represents a choice that should be informed by a hierarchy of priorities aimed at maximizing emotional impact.

Chapter 6 | Misdirection| Q&A

1.Question

What is the importance of emotion in film editing according to Walter Murch?

Answer:Emotion serves as the foundation of storytelling in film editing, taking precedence over other elements. Without emotional engagement, a story may lose its relevance and impact on the audience. It acts as the critical first filter in the

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editing process, ensuring that the essence of the narrative resonates with viewers.

2.Question

Who should the editor consider when making cuts in a film?

Answer:The editor should adopt the perspective of the audience, anticipating their thoughts and feelings at each moment of the film. This is essential for creating a seamless and engaging viewing experience, directing their attention where it matters most and affecting their emotional journey.

3.Question

How does Murch describe the relationship between story, emotion, and rhythm in editing?

Answer:Murch compares the relationship between these elements to the bonds of protons and neutrons in an atom, indicating that they are tightly interconnected. Prioritizing them in the right order ensures that a film remains cohesive and impactful.

4.Question

What metaphor does Walter Murch use to describe an

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editor's role?

Answer:He characterizes editors as everyday magicians, employing misdirection just like magicians do to guide the audience's focus and create an emotional experience. This analogy underscores the skill involved in effectively manipulating viewer attention.

5.Question

If an editor must make sacrifices, what should they prioritize according to Murch?

Answer:Editors should prioritize emotion over story, story over rhythm, rhythm over eye-trace, eye-trace over planarity, and planarity over spatial continuity. This hierarchy ensures that the core of the narrative remains intact while making necessary cuts.

6.Question

What does Murch caution against for editors during the editing process?

Answer:He warns that it’s easy to get lost in the minutiae of editing and lose sight of the overall narrative and emotional

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flow. Maintaining awareness of the larger picture is crucial for effective storytelling.

7.Question

What does Murch suggest editors aim for in their work?

Answer:Editors should strive for a harmonious balance among all six criteria he outlines—emotion, story, rhythm, eye-trace, planarity, and spatial continuity—never settling for less when a more comprehensive emotional and narrative experience is possible.

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Chapter 7 | Seeing Around the Edge of the Frame| Q&A

1.Question

How can an editor maintain perspective when viewing their work?

Answer:An editor can maintain perspective by imagining they are watching the finished film in a large theater filled with an audience, thus seeing the work as a complete piece rather than just the parts they are used to seeing in the editing room. This technique allows them to step back emotionally and critique the work as an outsider would.

2.Question

What does Walter Murch suggest is the danger of an editor being too close to the production?

Answer:The danger is that an editor may carry the emotional burden and context of the conditions under which the footage was shot, which can cloud their judgment. They might force themselves to favor certain shots due to the effort and resources invested in them, rather than prioritizing what truly

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serves the film.

3.Question

What strategy does Murch recommend for directors after shooting is complete?

Answer:Murch recommends that directors take time away from the project—ideally disconnecting from everything related to the film—to clear their minds. This approach helps prevent the confusion of the shooting process from influencing the editing stage, allowing them to approach their work with fresh eyes.

4.Question

Why is it important for an editor to detach from the shooting context?

Answer:Detachment is crucial because it allows the editor to focus solely on the images as seen by the audience, free from the behind-the-scenes struggles and emotions that can bias their decisions. This perspective helps them to make objective choices about what to include or exclude in the final cut.

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5.Question

What metaphor does Murch use to describe the physical size of film when editing?

Answer:Murch uses the metaphor of cutting out paper dolls to represent the audience's perspective. By placing the dolls on either side of the editing screen, he illustrates how these small figures help to enlarge the editor's view of the film, making the screen seem much larger and encouraging a broader perspective on the film as a whole.

6.Question

How does Murch believe an editor should perceive the moments captured on film?

Answer:Murch believes that an editor should perceive the moments captured on film without the influence of their knowledge of how those moments were created. They should strive to see only what is on screen, thus making decisions based on the emotional and narrative impact of the footage rather than its production history.

7.Question

What is the ultimate goal Murch mentions for the editor

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regarding the film?

Answer:The ultimate goal for the editor, as stated by Murch, is to balance their dreams for the film with the present reality of what is actually on the screen, ensuring they remain passionate about the potential of the film while being realistic about its current state.

Chapter 8 | Dreaming in Pairs| Q&A

1.Question

What role does the film editor play in the filmmaking process according to the chapter?

Answer:The film editor acts as a collaborator for the director, similar to how a text editor assists a writer. They encourage specific creative directions, advise on material to include, and help assemble images in a way that establishes the desired rhythm and narrative. This collaborative dynamic involves both the director and editor oscillating between roles to enhance the storytelling.

2.Question

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How does the concept of 'dreaming in pairs' relate to film editing?

Answer:The concept 'dreaming in pairs' highlights the importance of collaboration, where one party (the dreamer or director) shares their vision or dream, and the second party (the listener or editor) helps expand on and reveal deeper meanings or possibilities within that dream. This is akin to the editing process where the editor proposes alternate scenarios, prompting the director to consider fresh perspectives and enhance the overall narrative.

3.Question

What is the purpose of having a listener in dream therapy as discussed in the chapter?

Answer:The listener's purpose in dream therapy is to help the dreamer explore and uncover hidden aspects of their dreams. By proposing alternate interpretations or scenarios based on the dreamer's initial recollection, the listener facilitates a deeper understanding of the dream, allowing the dreamer to articulate and defend their memories, thereby leading to more

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significant revelations.

4.Question

How can the interaction between the dreamer and listener during dream therapy be compared to the editing process?

Answer:In both scenarios, the initial ideas or visions presented by the dreamer or director are challenged or expanded upon by the listener or editor. Just as a dreamer reacts to a proposed interpretation of their dream, prompting deeper insight, a director responds to an editor's suggestions, which can lead to a more refined and cohesive vision for the film.

5.Question

Why is it essential for the film editor to propose alternate scenarios during editing?

Answer:Proposing alternate scenarios is crucial because it allows the editor to provoke the director's imagination and uncover details that may have been overlooked. This process stimulates creativity and contributes to the film's overall coherence, ensuring that the final product is polished and

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fully realized.

6.Question

What parallels can be drawn between the creative processes of writing and filmmaking as described in the chapter?

Answer:Both processes involve a partnership where one party generates content (the writer or director) while the other refines and shapes it (the editor). Just as a text editor helps organize thoughts and ensures clarity in writing, a film editor crafts the sequence and rhythm of visuals, highlighting the collaborative nature of storytelling in both mediums.

Chapter 9 | Team Work:Multiple Editors| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of teamwork among editors in film editing?

Answer:Teamwork among editors is crucial in film editing due to the immense volume of material that needs to be processed. For instance, when a film has over 350,000 feet of workprint, having multiple

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editors can enhance speed and efficiency. This collaboration allows for a broader exploration of creative avenues, improving the overall quality of the film despite the risk of coherence. The challenge of managing multiple perspectives can lead to richer storytelling, as seen in films like 'The Godfather' where the complexity warranted the collaboration of multiple editors.

2.Question

What are the risks and rewards of using multiple editors?

Answer:The main reward of using multiple editors is the speed at which the film can be assembled, allowing for timely releases and potentially saving significant production costs. However, the risk lies in achieving coherence and unity in the final product, as different editors may have varying visions and styles. The experience from 'Apocalypse Now' illustrates this, as a higher cut-per-day rate allowed the team to explore numerous creative paths before converging on the final edit.

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3.Question

How does the leadership dynamic between directors and editors impact the editing process?

Answer:The dynamic between directors and editors is pivotal; at times, the editor must act as a dreamer, seeking to uncover deeper narratives, while the director plays the role of a listener, guiding the vision. If the director and editor have not established a common language, it can lead to a 'locked viewpoint' that hampers creativity. 'The Godfather' series exemplified a shift from single to multiple editors to mitigate such risks and better align the editing process with the director’s vision.

4.Question

Why might it be beneficial to have two editors instead of one on a film?

Answer:Having two editors can significantly enhance the efficiency of the editing process, especially under tight deadlines. This was evident in 'The Godfather,' where the original editor's lack of flexibility led to the hiring of a

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second editor to manage the workload effectively. With dual editors, there is also the advantage of diverse perspectives being applied to the material, increasing the potential for innovative storytelling.

5.Question

How can the quality of editing influence a film's release schedule?

Answer:The quality and efficiency of editing directly affect a film’s release schedule. For example, with the financial cost of interest on a large budget film, hiring an additional editor can accelerate the editing process, minimizing delays. As articulated through the experiences shared in 'Apocalypse Now,' achieving a high cut-per-day rate through collaborative editing not only ensures timely release but also enhances the exploration of creative alternatives, crucial for delivering a compelling final product.

6.Question

What does Walter Murch mean by 'the quality of the bait determines the kind of fish you catch' in the context of editing?

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Answer:This metaphor suggests that the decisions made during the editing process—essentially the choices editors make—determine the narrative depth and emotional resonance of the final film. The 'bait' represents the creative choices and techniques used in editing, which draw out the best elements from the footage, akin to how different bait attracts different fish.

7.Question

How can the editing process shape a film's narrative?

Answer:Editing is essentially where the story is truly crafted; choices made during editing can significantly alter the pacing, tone, and emotional impact of a film. In 'The Godfather Part II,' the way scenes were re-cut and restructured revealed new meanings and connections that may not have been seen in the original assembly, highlighting how editing shapes the narrative.

8.Question

What lessons can we learn about collaboration from the experiences shared in Chapter 9?

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Answer:Chapter 9 emphasizes the importance of collaboration and open communication in any creative endeavor. It demonstrates that allowing multiple perspectives can lead to richer insights and a more polished outcome, reflecting the idea that collaborative efforts often yield superior results compared to solitary work, especially in high-stakes environments like film production.

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Chapter 10 | The Decisive Moment| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of capturing a 'decisive moment' in filmmaking?

Answer:Capturing a 'decisive moment' allows filmmakers to distill the essence of a scene into a single image that embodies complex emotions and storytelling. This concept, articulated by Henri Cartier-Bresson, means that the selected frame can communicate nuanced feelings that words often fail to express, creating a profound connection with the audience.

2.Question

How do still photographs from dailies aid in the editing process?

Answer:Still photographs taken from dailies serve as visual references that summarize complex scenes, help resolve discussions about the shoot with the director, and provide a visual record of subtle details that continuity notes may miss.

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They assist in selecting the right images that convey emotions effectively when editing.

3.Question

In what ways do photographs provide insights beyond written descriptions or continuity notes?

Answer:Photographs capture specific expressions, physical nuances, and emotional subtleties that are often labeled as nameless emotions, allowing directors to communicate their vision more clearly. The visual elements in a photograph can illustrate complex emotional dynamics that are difficult to describe verbally.

4.Question

Why is it challenging for an editor to maintain freshness when reviewing dailies?

Answer:Editors might face a mental glaze from seeing numerous takes in a row, leading to decreased sensitivity and awareness; each frame competes for their attention just as actors do in a casting session. To counter this, editors must actively engage their perception to remain open to the

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possibilities and uniqueness of each shot.

5.Question

How can juxtaposing different photographs lead to new artistic insights?

Answer:By displaying photographs side by side, editors can create unexpected connections that spark new ideas and editorial directions. This method of organization allows for creative leaps that may not arise from simply reviewing film in a linear format, enhancing the storytelling process.

6.Question

What role do emotions play in the selection of frames for a film?

Answer:Emotions are central to the selection of frames, as editors seek images that encapsulate the complex feelings within a scene. The chosen frames must resonate emotionally to convey the intended atmosphere and character dynamics effectively, guiding the viewer's interpretation of the narrative.

7.Question

How did the photographic process described by Murch

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affect the overall filmmaking experience?

Answer:The photographic process facilitated clear communication between the director and editor, enhanced the understanding of the visual narrative, and preserved valuable emotional nuances from the shoot. This practice enriched the collaborative effort of filmmaking, ultimately leading to a more cohesive final product.

Chapter 11 | Methods and Machines: Marble and Clay| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of choosing representative stills from dailies during the editing process?

Answer:Choosing representative stills from every setup encourages an analytical approach to editing rather than passively watching dailies roll by. This act itself begins the editorial process by allowing the editor to start making choices about which frames are most impactful or relevant, laying the groundwork for the actual editing work that follows.

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2.Question

How does the choice of editing machine affect the editing process, according to Walter Murch?

Answer:Different editing machines influence how an editor interacts with the material. For instance, the Moviola allows for a more tactile, physical engagement—as if the editor is dancing with the machine—while the KEM offers a linear approach that can trigger creative insights as the editor views footage rapidly in order. The tools shape not just the efficiency but the very experience of editing and the final product.

3.Question

What metaphor does Murch use to describe the editing process?

Answer:Murch compares editing to surgery, cooking, and dancing. He emphasizes that just like a dancer stands to perform, an editor should ideally stand while editing to fully engage with the material, suggesting that the act of editing is a dynamic, physical, and creative craft.

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4.Question

Why is it important for an editor like Walter Murch to revisit dailies after an initial assembly?

Answer:Revisiting dailies after a first cut allows the editor to see the material with fresh eyes, having evolved alongside the film itself throughout the editing process. This reflection can reveal new insights and possibilities that weren't apparent during the first viewing, helping to align the film's emergent voice with the editing choices.

5.Question

What is the 'golden mean' Murch talks about in relation to editing systems?

Answer:Murch describes a 'golden mean' as the ideal balance between too much chaos (in a fully random-access system) and too much rigidity (in a purely linear system). Effective editing should offer a degree of unpredictability to stimulate creativity while still allowing for organized access to material.

6.Question

How does Murch describe his reaction to finding shots

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that he originally deemed unusable?

Answer:Murch suggests that what may seem unusable at first can turn out to be invaluable upon re-examination. This highlights the importance of keeping an open mind and the potential for discovery within the editing process, suggesting that revisiting initial judgments can lead to unexpected creative breakthroughs.

7.Question

What does Murch mean by saying that editing should reach a point where he no longer 'sees himself' in the material?

Answer:When Murch no longer sees himself in the material, it indicates that the film has started to achieve a life of its own, where the characters, emotion, and story take precedence. This reflects a successful editing process where the editor's personal judgments recede, allowing the authentic narrative to emerge.

Chapter 12 | Test Screenings: Referred Pain| Q&A

1.Question

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What role does audience participation play in the filmmaking process according to Walter Murch?

Answer:Walter Murch suggests that audience participation is essential for completing the final ten percent of a film, as it provides valuable feedback that can reveal blind spots the creators may have due to their familiarity with the material. He argues that the audience serves as collaborators who can offer insights and corrections that help refine the film.

2.Question

How does the concept of 'referred pain' relate to audience feedback in test screenings?

Answer:Murch uses the analogy of 'referred pain' to explain how audience feedback can sometimes misidentify the actual source of dissatisfaction with a film. Just as a doctor must look beyond the expressed pain in the elbow to find the true cause, filmmakers need to analyze audience reactions to discover underlying issues, rather than merely addressing

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complaints about specific scenes.

3.Question

What should editors and directors do when they receive critical feedback from test screenings?

Answer:Editors and directors should carefully consider the feedback without making hasty changes. They must assess whether the feedback points to actual problems with scenes or whether the audience's confusion stems from a lack of understanding that could be resolved with better exposition earlier in the film.

4.Question

Why does Murch caution against responding directly to audience feedback in test screenings?

Answer:Murch cautions that direct responses to audience feedback can lead to misguided edits. Audience members may describe their discomfort without accurately identifying its source, which can result in editing decisions that solve surface-level issues while ignoring deeper narrative problems.

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5.Question

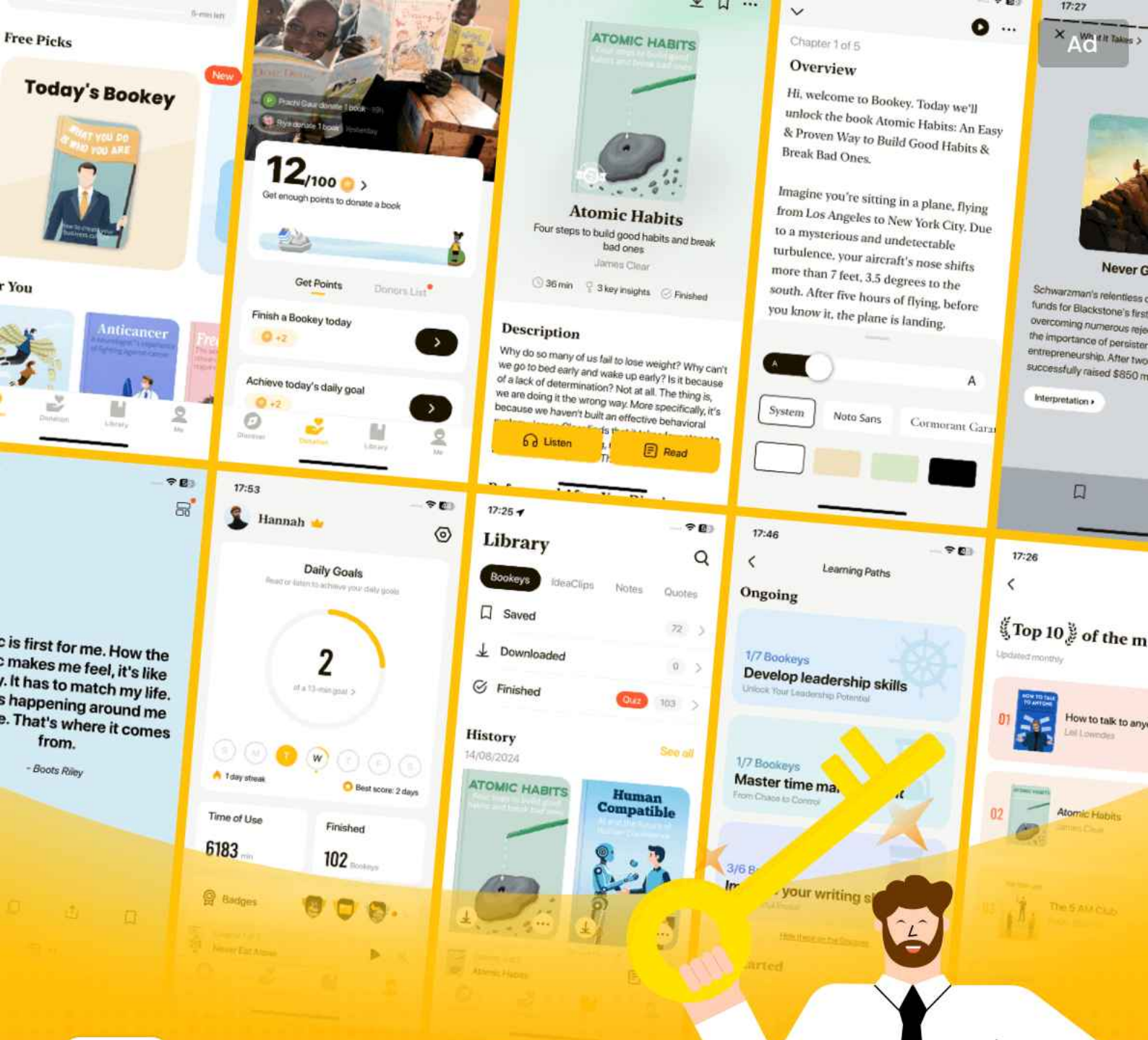
What strategies did Murch find effective for gathering audience feedback?

Answer:Murch found that gathering feedback a few days after the screening—rather than immediately—helps provide more thoughtful insights. This approach allows audiences to reflect on the film and articulate their feelings with greater clarity, leading to more useful feedback.

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Chapter 13 | Don't Worry,It's Only a Movie| Q&A

1.Question

What does Walter Murch suggest about the process of removing scenes in film editing?

Answer:Murch reflects on the difficult decision to remove a scene that had once seemed essential but ultimately was not needed, suggesting that sometimes, what we think is crucial can actually become excess once the project's emotional core has been established. He compares this decision to cutting the 'umbilical cord' that connects an idea to its creator, realizing that once that emotional connection is established through other scenes, the extra scene can be removed without losing the film's heart.

2.Question

How does Murch relate the act of cutting in film to the experience of dreams?

Answer:Murch posits that both films and dreams disrupt the

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continuity of our waking reality through sudden juxtapositions and cuts. Just as we accept disjointed, rapidly shifting images in dreams, we also accept the cuts in films. This acceptance allows us to experience film as a dream-like state, evoking emotions and sensations that may bypass our defenses, akin to how we react to unsettling dreams.

3.Question

In what way does John Huston's comment about film relate to the cognitive process of how we perceive reality?

Answer:Huston argues that films mimic our thought processes, suggesting that the experience of watching a film is akin to visual thinking. He illustrates this by comparing how we might blink while transitioning our gaze from one object to another, signifying natural cuts we make in our perception, mirroring the cuts we see in film editing. This reflects how we process and categorize information, emphasizing that our perception of the world is inherently discontinuous.

4.Question

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What significance does Murch attach to the act of blinking in relation to thought and conversation?

Answer:Murch observes that the timing of a person's blink is often in sync with their understanding of a conversation—blinking at moments of realization or transition, much like a visual cut in film helps punctuate ideas. This link illustrates that blinks serve as a cognitive mechanism, allowing us to process and delineate thoughts, akin to how cuts in editing separate ideas or sequences within a narrative.

5.Question

How does Murch connect the physical act of blinking to emotional states?

Answer:Murch suggests that variations in blinking can indicate emotional states—times of anger may result in fewer blinks, showing a fixation on a single thought, while frantic blinking can signify emotional overload and the need to process conflicting thoughts. This reinforces the idea that our physiological responses are deeply intertwined with our

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cognitive processes and emotional experiences, both in conversation and filmmaking.

6.Question

What does Murch mean when he says that our perception must render visual reality discontinuous?

Answer:Murch asserts that to make sense of the ongoing flow of visual information in the real world, we need to create discontinuities and separations—similar to how film editing operates. By segmenting experiences into discrete ideas, we provide ourselves with a framework for understanding reality without being overwhelmed by a continuous stream of information, thereby drawing a parallel to how we interpret fragmented narratives in films.

Chapter 14 | Dragnet| Q&A

1.Question

How can an actor's blinking provide insights into their character's emotions?

Answer:An actor's blinking can reflect the internal rhythms of their character's emotions and thoughts.

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If an actor truly embodies their character, their blinks will occur in sync with the character’s thoughts, which allows the audience to feel the authenticity of the performance. For example, in Walter Murch's observation of Gene Hackman's performance in 'The Conversation', Hackman's timing of blinks aligned perfectly with Harry Caul's thoughts, creating a seamless connection that heightened the realism of the film.

2.Question

What editing technique does Murch criticize and why?

Answer:Murch criticizes the 'Dragnet' editing technique for its rigid adherence to cutting between speakers, which fails to capture the organic flow of natural conversations. This method, while simple, lacks the depth and grammatical nuance found in real-life dialogues. By only cutting based on who is speaking, it ignores the complex emotional exchanges and reactions that occur in interactions, resulting in a disjointed portrayal of communication.

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3.Question

Explain how the concept of blinking relates to film editing.

Answer:Blinking serves as a metaphor for cut points in film editing. Murch suggests that the rhythm and timing of blinks can guide editors in identifying potential cut points in a scene. Just as our natural tendency to blink aligns with the flow of conversation, effective cuts should resonate with the audience's engagement and understanding of the narrative. By aligning cuts with natural blinking rhythms, editors can enhance the emotional impact and pacing of a scene.

4.Question

What strategy does Murch propose for selecting cut points during editing?

Answer:Murch proposes that editors should choose cut points in real time, mirroring the rhythms established by the actor's performance rather than meticulously combing through frames. This real-time selection encourages an instinctual and rhythmic approach to editing, ensuring that

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cuts feel natural and are psychologically interesting, echoing the thought processes of the audience.

5.Question

How does the relationship between blinking and cutting affect audience perception?

Answer:The relationship between blinking and cutting can significantly influence how audiences perceive and understand the film's narrative. By cutting at moments that align with the audience’s natural blinking patterns, editors can guide emotional responses and maintain engagement. If cuts are made at inappropriate moments, it can disrupt the flow and create a sense of dissonance, hindering the audience’s ability to connect with the story.

6.Question

Why is it important for an editor to anticipate the audience's thought process?

Answer:Anticipating the audience's thought process allows editors to create a film that feels both engaging and intuitive. Murch emphasizes that editors must provide what the

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audience needs before they consciously 'ask' for it, balancing surprise with familiarity. By doing so, editors can maintain a flow that feels natural and exciting, enhancing the overall viewing experience.

7.Question

What lesson can filmmakers learn from Murch's insights on rhythm and cutting?

Answer:Filmmakers can learn that both rhythm and emotional honesty are crucial in guiding audience reactions. By carefully considering the timing of cuts, mirroring natural human rhythms like blinking, filmmakers can create a more immersive and compelling narrative that resonates emotionally with viewers.

Chapter 15 | A Galaxy of Winking Dots| Q&A

1.Question

What does Walter Murch suggest about the relationship between audience blinking and engagement with a film?

Answer:Murch suggests that when an audience is fully engaged with a film, their blinking may occur

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in rhythm with the film, indicating a collective emotional response. This synchronized blinking could signal that the film is effectively capturing the audience's attention, whereas scattered blinking might suggest distraction or disengagement.

2.Question

How does Murch relate the experience of watching a movie to physiological responses like coughing and blinking?

Answer:Murch compares the control of coughs in a concert setting to blinking during a film. He notes that if an audience is truly immersed in the performance, they can subconsciously suppress involuntary reactions like coughing, similar to how they might control their blinking during intense moments in a film.

3.Question

What might an infrared film of an audience reveal about their experience, according to Murch?

Answer:An infrared film could visually depict the 'galaxy of winking dots' created by audience members' eyes. If many

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dots blinked in unison, it would indicate a shared emotional or cognitive connection to the film, showing that the audience is deeply engaged. Conversely, random blinking patterns may signal a loss of focus.

4.Question

In what way does Murch illustrate the impact of artistry in controlling audience response?

Answer:Murch references pianist Sviatoslav Richter's performance during a flu epidemic, where his artistry was so compelling that it suppressed the natural urges of coughing among his audience. This example illustrates how powerful performance can influence physiological responses, creating deep immersion in the art.

5.Question

What insights does Murch provide about non-verbal communication through blinking?

Answer:Murch implies that blinking can communicate unspoken messages and feelings, such as discomfort or disengagement during a conversation. Subtle variations in a

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person's blinking can reveal their level of attentiveness or emotional state, thus serving as a significant non-verbal cue.

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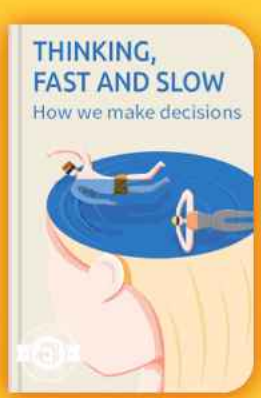
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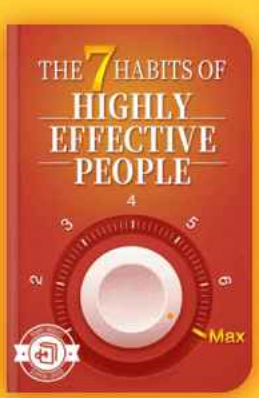
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Chapter 1 | Cuts and Shadow Cuts| Quiz and Test

1. Walter Murch recorded an unprecedented 1,250,000 feet of film during the post-production of 'Apocalypse Now'.
2. The rate of cuts made by each editor during the editing of 'Apocalypse Now' was 1.47 cuts per day.
3. Editing in filmmaking is only about counting the number of cuts made.

Chapter 2 | Why Do Cuts Work?| Quiz and Test

1. The editing process is primarily about splicing film rather than discovering a path.
2. Film editing allows filmmakers to create sharper, more impactful films through the technique of discontinuity.
3. Discontinuity in filmmaking is purely a practical concern without any emotional or narrative benefits.

Chapter 3 | "Cut Out the Bad Bits"| Quiz and Test

1. Walter Murch believes that film editing is simply

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about cutting out 'bad bits.'

2. Murch compares editing to genetic similarities between humans and chimpanzees, noting that both share nearly identical 'DNA.'

3. All editors will produce the same film from identical raw footage regardless of their individual choices.

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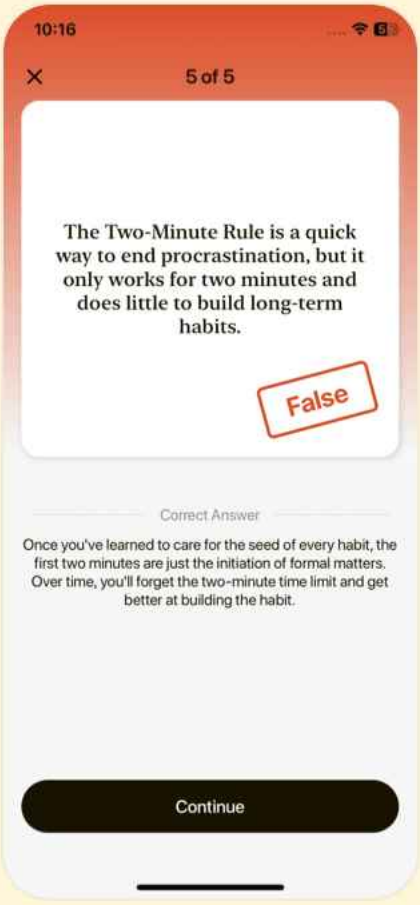
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Chapter 4 | Most with the Least| Quiz and Test

1. Walter Murch discusses difficulties faced in filmmaking using a chimpanzee film intended for human audiences as an example.
2. Murch believes that having more sound mix tracks always results in a higher quality of sound.
3. Murch's minimalist approach is applicable only to editing in filmmaking.

Chapter 5 | The Rule of Six| Quiz and Test

1. Editors should cut films merely to meet a quota for cuts.
2. The primary factor in evaluating cuts according to the Rule of Six is emotion.
3. Three-dimensional continuity is the primary factor in evaluating cuts according to Murch's Rule of Six.

Chapter 6 | Misdirection| Quiz and Test

1. The six critical criteria for film editing are emotion, story, rhythm, eye-trace, planarity, and spatial continuity.

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2.Editors should prioritize spatial continuity over emotion when editing a film.

3.A film editor's role is similar to that of a magician, directing the audience's attention and emotions through editing techniques.

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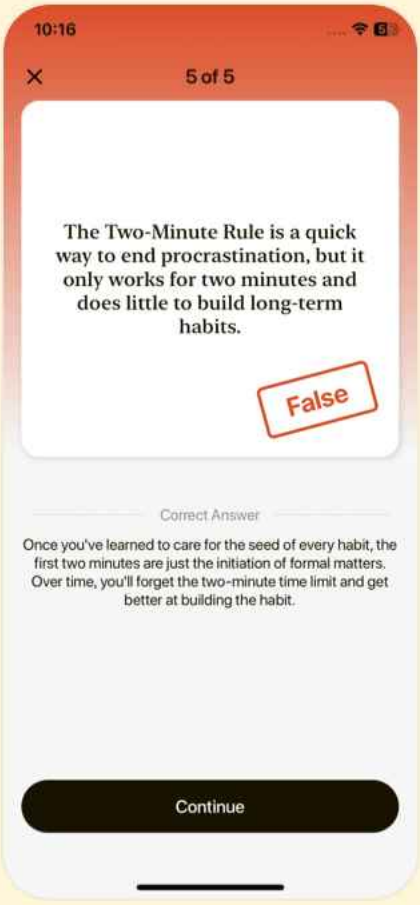
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Chapter 7 | Seeing Around the Edge of the Frame| Quiz and Test

1. Walter Murch believes that editors should view the footage as an audience would, without emotional baggage.
2. Murch suggests that directors should immediately jump into editing after shooting to maintain their insights about the footage.
3. According to Murch, separating the experiences of shooting and editing is crucial for filmmakers.

Chapter 8 | Dreaming in Pairs| Quiz and Test

1. In filmmaking, the editor and director have a relationship similar to that of a text editor and a writer.
2. Dream therapy involves the listener interpreting dreams long after the dreamer has woken up.
3. The film editor helps the director explore alternative scenarios, much like a dream listener does for a dreamer.

Chapter 9 | Team Work:Multiple

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Editors| Quiz and Test

1. In film editing, editors and directors have a collaboration that often relies on the quality of ideas from the director.
2. The use of multiple editors in film projects is uncommon and primarily reserved for directors of photography.
3. A single editor is always preferable to handle a film, as they maintain a consistent vision without distractions.

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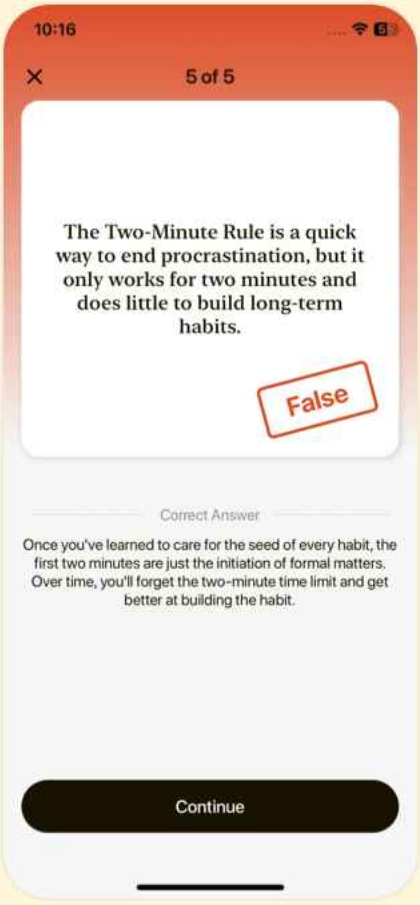
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Chapter 10 | The Decisive Moment| Quiz and Test

1. Walter Murch edited *The Unbearable Lightness of Being* while Phil Kaufman filmed it in Paris and sent him daily footage for review.
2. Murch used photographs from each camera setup as part of his editing process to capture and organize details beyond typical continuity notes.
3. The photographs used by Murch were only for maintaining continuity and had no impact on the emotional presentation of the film.

Chapter 11 | Methods and Machines: Marble and Clay| Quiz and Test

1. Murch prefers the KEM editing machine for its ability to sculpt film pieces individually.
2. Murch emphasizes the importance of reviewing dailies multiple times to recognize previously overlooked possibilities.
3. The ideal moment in editing is when the editor feels that the film's narrative is dictated by their choices.

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Chapter 12 | Test Screenings: Referred Pain| Quiz and Test

1. Fred Zinnemann believed the last ten percent of a film's completion relies solely on audience feedback, ignoring contributions from directors and editors.
2. Francis Coppola preferred early test screenings with a mixture of familiar and unfamiliar viewers to gauge emotional reactions to films.
3. Test screenings directly show filmmakers exactly what fixes are needed based on immediate audience reactions.

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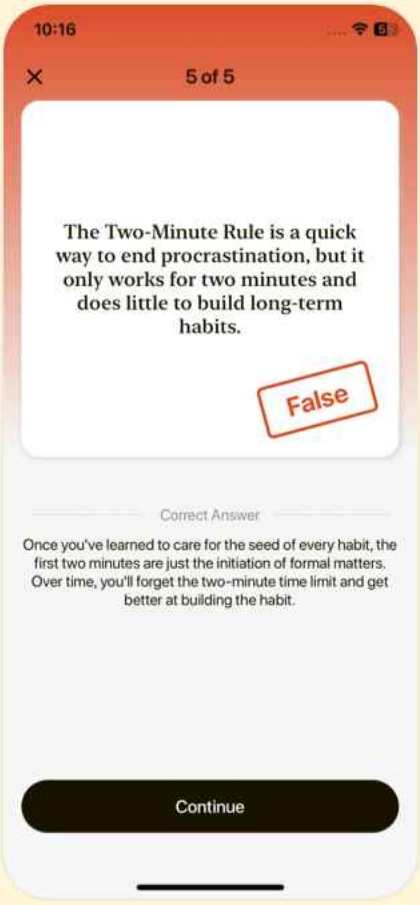
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Chapter 13 | Don't Worry,It's Only a Movie| Quiz and Test

1. Walter Murch believes that cutting film can sometimes enhance the emotional resonance of the story being told.
2. Murch argues that the process of cutting film is smooth and non-disruptive, closely resembling continuous real-life perception.
3. Murch suggests that the act of blinking has a direct relationship with how we process thoughts and emotions, similar to the cuts made in films.

Chapter 14 | Dragnet| Quiz and Test

1. The rhythm of an actor's blinking does not impact their emotional expression and character portrayal.
2. The 'Dragnet' editing style effectively captures the emotional complexity of conversations.
3. Effective pacing in film editing should reflect the natural blinking rates of humans during different scenes.

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Chapter 15 | A Galaxy of Winking Dots| Quiz and Test

1. Walter Murch believes that when an audience is engrossed in a film, their blinking will synchronize with the rhythm of the movie.
2. Murch's infrared imagery technique captures audience members' blinking as an indication of distraction rather than engagement.
3. According to Murch, blinking can serve as a subconscious cue in everyday interactions regarding attentiveness and engagement.

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